Wind near the ocean surface is blowing from different directions converging and causing air to rise and storm clouds to form.

Winds which do not vary greatly with height are known as low wind shear. This allows the storm clouds to rise vertically to high level;

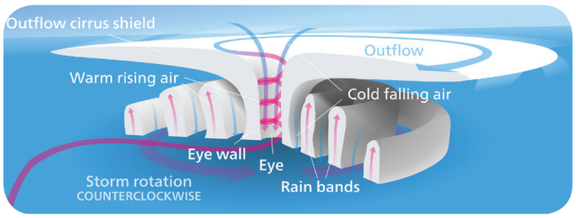


Figure 6.29 Structure of Tropical Cyclone

Coriolis force is induced by the rotation of the Earth. The mechanisms of formation vary across the world, but once a cluster of storm clouds starts to rotate, it becomes a tropical depression. If it continues to develop it becomes a tropical storm, and later a cyclone/ super cyclone.

Characteristics of the Tropical Cyclone

The centre of the cyclone where the wind system converges and vertically rises is called as Eye. The eye is a Calm region with no rainfall and experiences highest temperature and lowest pressure within the cyclonic system (Figure 6.30).

Cyclone wall is made up of Cumulo Nimbus clouds with no visibility, higher wind velocity and heavy rain fall with lightning and thunder.

Tropical cyclones mostly move along with the direction of trade wind system. So they travel from east to west and make land fall on the eastern coast of the continents (Figure 6.31).

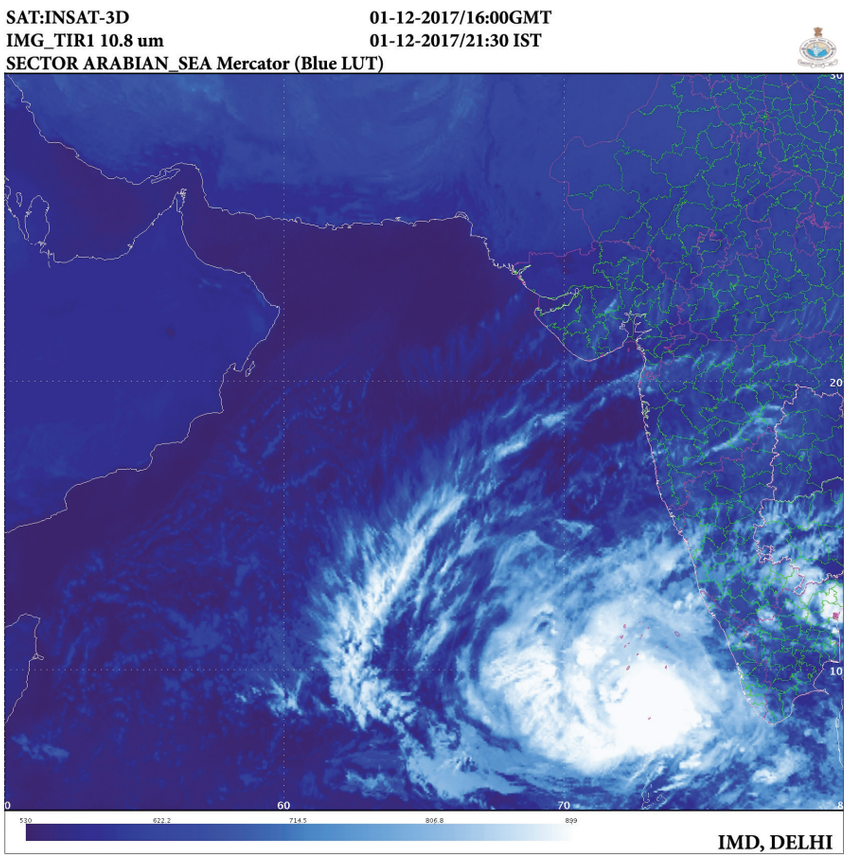


Figure 6.30 Track of Tropical cyclone

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